

1992 is a decisive date for the citizens of the European Community. It falls in the very middle of the term of office of the European Parliament which we are going to elect. By our participation, we can play a leading role in adopting the decisions which **will** shape the European Community of the future.

We want a Community which is united, prosperous, displays solidarity, is fit to live in, democratic and open to the World.

The '92 horizon represents the achievement of a Community without frontiers, in which there is freedom of movement for people, goods, services and capital. We must choose which Community: a common area with more freedom only for business, or an area with more employment and social progress; a land where we can live with a protected environment or the irreversible destruction of nature. The Socialists of the European Community affirm that there must be a step in common towards the creation of a freer, more prosperous and more just society.

We want a United Europe

because we consider that it is through unity, freely consented to by our peoples, that we can live in peace and prosperity in today's world. History has shown that the decision to join our peoples in a common destiny, whilst respecting their diversity, has given us a period of unprecedented peace and cooperation.

No country in Europe can confront the challenges of our time alone. Only European cooperation can guarantee peace, ensure the protection of the environment and make social progress possible.

As it approaches its second centenary, the slogan of the 1789 revolutionaries - Liberty, Equality, Fraternity - continues to be valid. It is not a utopian or outmoded ideal to seek to extend human rights, to enhance social justice and to guarantee equality of opportunity.

Our struggle for human rights, for the achievement of social justice and for equality of opportunity has brought us to a situation in which the citizens of the European Community live, to a great extent, in a society based on liberty, a high standard of social protection and a better quality of life.

44 million people, however, out of the 320 million inhabitants of the Community, live in poverty. The consolidation of social justice and the fight against poverty are threatened by conservative policies. The creation of the internal market presents both opportunities and problems. The only way that 1992 can be favourable to the interests of all E.C. citizens is through the integration of both the economic and social aspects. We cannot accept an internal market without democratic control, or in which the social dimension is ignored.

It is for this reason that it is necessary to establish an active social policy at European Community level, which must be given equal importance with economic and agricultural policy. For Socialists, the European Community must guarantee to each citizen, man or woman (whether employed or retired), the benefit of social security, a job and acceptable living and working conditions.

The constructive work that we wish to do together to develop a harmonious global programme includes:

- the completion of the internal market, with a selective and co-operative strategy of growth to create employment, accompanied by economic and monetary unity;
- solidarity between the States and regions of the Community through the convergence of levels of economic development,
- Social Europe, based on high levels of social protection and dialogue between the social partners, an effective health and social security system and also redistribution of benefits to society as a whole, with particular attention to those in need.
- the protection of the environment throughout the whole of Europe must be a condition for the balanced development of our societies, taking into account technological and scientific aspects.

-The democratic construction of Europe. The Community is inspired by fundamental democratic principles and is made up of twelve States which are parliamentary democracies. This requires progress to be made at institutional level, so that the citizens' Europe can really be created.

We wish to construct a zone of balance and cooperation for security in Europe. Common ties and trust are our best ways to work in that direction.

For Socialists, the true affirmation of the citizens' Europe, with democratic institutions, in which we can all exercise the right to vote as Europeans, is the key to the Community which we wish to build. The more important the Community becomes, the stronger the European Parliament will be. The construction of Europe must not be left in the hands of bureaucrats and ministers [alone. it](#) must be a People's EUREPE. (')

We want a prosperous

with sufficient economic and monetary capacity to generate the economic growth that we need to create employment and welfare.

We need selective economic growth with priority objectives: the creation of employment, economic cohesion, social welfare, protection of the environment and solidarity with the Third World.

The European Community, with a selective and cooperative strategy of growth, can become a dynamic area within the world's economy in the next decade, a focus of activity which can actively contribute to the achievement of commercial stability in the world as a whole, avoiding the ups and downs to which we are subject at world level because of instability in financial matters and decision-making.

Moreover, we shall thereby be able to achieve the industrial and technological progress necessary to enable us to face the challenge posed by the U.S.A. and Japan and the New Industrialised Countries. At the same time, we shall be able to make a decisive contribution to the creation of a new international economic order which **will** facilitate greater growth in the developing countries and a solution to the

... ..

We propose a policy which is:

Coordinated, with a growth potential greater than the sum of those of the individual Member States, which will enable us to take advantage of the beneficial effects of the opening of frontiers. To that end, it is necessary for the Institutions to be capable of generating expansionist policies. It is necessary to seek convergence through the establishment of policies for industry, research, technology, transport, and financial and monetary policy. Diversified, in order to take advantage of our respective existing margins of manoeuvre. The expansionary effect of enlargement is not sufficient. The strongest economies of the E.E.C. must adopt policies for sustainable and balanced economic growth in order to favour the creation of jobs and prosperity for all, and to promote economic and social cohesion.

Selective, because growth by itself will not be enough to eliminate unemployment. Unemployment is a general problem with different national and regional situations. This is why it must be combatted through selective and qualitative measures which take account of all factors and situations.

The creation of employment continues to be our highest priority. It is necessary for us to follow an active policy oriented towards the creation of jobs. The Community must guarantee to the more than 16 million people without work the right to work at a time when its wealth is increasing. We must guarantee equality of rights and opportunities for men, women and young people.

The importance of the quality of general education justifies efforts to achieve high standards for the full development of the individual personality, as well as for the improvement of professional skills in future. In fact, today, unemployment hits hardest those whose level of education and training is insuffi-

- The involvement of firms, and especially those which are developing methods for the future, in plans for training young people and women - an objective of major importance. The EEC, along with the social partners, must promote plans to prolong professional training within firms, thus contributing to the breakdown of barriers which prevent the access of young people and women to employment.
- Every young person, male or female, in the EC should receive professional training. The Community and its Member States must join forces to ensure the continuation and intensification of the exchange programmes for young workers and students and to take into account equality of opportunity between boys and girls.
- As a complement to industrial cooperation within the EC, closer cooperation between the universities of the Member States has to be realised. The strengthening of the common university network opens up possibilities in this area, the potential of which must be increased. -As for higher education, our universities must receive the same priorities as industry. By the mid 1990s, one in ten students must be able to continue his or her studies in another member country for at least one year.

The process of industrial reorganisation, which is already under way within Europe, will be further strengthened by the development of the Internal Market. Whilst European companies are already recognising the need for cross-border collaboration via mergers and friendly share-swaps, it is necessary to have clearly thought-out competition and strong industrial policies to alleviate problems associated with the concentration and centralisation of production and services. To this end, industrial and regional policies need to be considerably strengthened to enable an equitable distribution of economic growth throughout the Community, so that 1992 will benefit all Community citizens.

The establishment of the Internal Market will call for sectoral adjustments and regional redistribution. Accordingly, what is needed is a Common Industrial Policy, both in the sectors which look to the future and involve advanced technology, and in the traditional sectors, in order to make them more competitive. At the same time, a Community-wide infrastructure programme must provide us with a system of transport facilities, with emphasis on public transport and a modern telecommunications system, which will give real substance to the concept of a Community without frontiers.

Our best response is to give the greatest priority to enhancing our best resources, namely human resources. This requires expansion of the Social Fund, in order to develop vocational training and pool our experience, so as to guarantee continuing education and a concern to ensure quality.

Scientific and technological research are essential. Alongside other initiatives promoted by organisations, research centres, or by governments, we consider that the implementation of the multiannual framework programme for research (as well as, ERASMUS, COMETT, etc) will permit us to pool our hitherto scattered efforts, and is essential in order to guarantee a central role for the Community in the advanced sectors of the economy.

A rational redistribution of work¹ would be an effective means to fight against unemployment. Forms of work reduction - in the framework of the 35-hour week - as well as flexibility of working time, should take into account the increased productivity of companies and be the subject of negotiations. Likewise, the management of non-renewable natural resources can lead to the creation of new jobs and to improvements in the quality of life.

In addition to public efforts, which are necessary to increase employment, we recognise the significant role which com-

panies play in their ever-increasing trans-border activities within an integrated Community market.

It is essential, therefore, for workers to be fully associated with the development strategies of companies, by organising information and worker participation in decision-making, within the framework of existing models, traditions and experience.

As Socialists, we consider that the small and medium-sized enterprises and co-operative sectors can play a stabilizing role at the economic and social level, particularly as concerns supply and demand of labour.

International monetary instability, caused by balance of payments disequilibrium and speculative fluctuations in capital movements, is a factor in restricting economic growth and is hampering the recovery of productive investment. Better international co-operation is essential for the organisation of a more stable international exchange rate system based on responsible economic and monetary policies.

European monetary cohesion, over the last ten years or so, has found partial and incomplete expression in the EMS. This should be transformed to improve its operations and give it greater coherence. With its commercial strength and internal market, the EC cannot sacrifice its economic and social policies because of fluctuations in external currencies such as the Yen and the Dollar. Here, as elsewhere, the interests of the people of the Community must prevail.

There would be great advantage in strengthening European monetary cohesion by introducing binding arrangements for consultation between the monetary authorities, with a view to co-ordinating national intervention and monetary policies relating both to exchange rate relationships and to the definition of a new, more stable and more balanced international monetary system.

The EMS is one means of achieving this European monetary identity, whose aim would be to defend Community citizens' interests and to create the conditions for more balanced economic growth. The EMS must not be an end in itself; it is an instrument for ensuring better exchange rate stability; but it must also allow the introduction of expansionorientated, non-inflationary economic policies.

The aim of the EMS could be achieved by integrating the European currencies that are not yet part of the exchange rate system, but this would have to be in such a way as to take account of the different economic conditions within individual countries and must be accompanied by measures to prevent the financial disruption referred to above.

Any reinforcement of monetary cohesion in the Community, within the perspective of the establishment of a European Monetary Fund, cannot be achieved unless there is better democratic control of monetary policy, with one of the objectives being to avoid anarchy in the integrated European capital market.

From a financial point of view, the integration of capital markets obliges the Community to have a coherent system of rules and information procedures, in order to realise transparency of transactions and the control of the manner of acquisition of stocks and shares of companies (commercial, financial and industrial), in order to protect the workers' and savers' legitimate interests and to ensure that the objectives carried out are compatible with political and social considerations.

The completion of the integrated capital market should favour economic development, growth and employment in the Community, in particular by an optimal financing and at lower investment costs.

Common measures should be taken against **fiscal fraud and** tax evasion. A situation must not be reached where income from labour alone is subject to taxation. (')

In the agricultural sector, the reforms which are already under way and which use the system of stabilisers and socio-structural measures to avoid unwanted over-production and to protect small scale producers - especially those from less-favoured regions - must be continued.

More importance must be given to the relationship between agriculture and the environment. Food production, which respects the environment, must be encouraged. Similar norms must be introduced for the production, treatment and distribution of food. This approach is necessary, not only to ensure that food products are not contaminated with harmful chemical products, but also to protect consumers and nature. Clean air, clean water, unpolluted soil are vital priorities. Farmers must be employed not only to produce food but also to protect and revive the countryside. In the same way, the encouragement of the planting of woodland as an alternative, promotes conservation, and can Supplement the resources of small farmers in disadvantaged regions.

It is in the interest of all of Europe that we stabilise and preserve rural communities. The increased Structural Funds offer an opportunity to develop these communities through integrated development programmes. This is necessary in order to raise the standard of living in many disadvantaged areas, by improving services and amenities and by the creation of alternative employment, including part-time employment, for small farmers and their families who are not fully employed on the land.

A balance in the agricultural markets, via production and commercial agreements, must be re-established. These must take into account the interests of developing countries within the framework of the GATT negotiations.

Fishing is an economic activity which has a high level of employment, while its industrialisation and commercialisation are of great importance: maintaining, improving its possibilities and modernising the sector, taking into account the conservation of fish stocks and the ecological balance, is an essential task to be carried out in the near future.

Concern for the social aspects of the fishery sector must be translated into reforms, which are necessary in order to provide workers at sea with the same conditions as other workers.

The peripheral, maritime, and insular regions of the Community present specific problems which require special solutions.

Building Europe is not a process of negative integration, of the systematic abolition of rules, as is asserted by the proponents of 'deregulation'. The making of the Community is a common task of positive contraction.

We want a Community which displays solidarity,

comprising a common economic and social area, not merely a freetrade area. We therefore consider that the development of the internal market must go hand in hand with an active policy of economic and social cohesion.

In the Community of Twelve, there are enormous differences in stages of development and in living conditions. More than 60 million Community citizens live in areas where the per capita income is 25% or more lower than the Community average. It must also be borne in mind that the process of creating the internal market is not going to spread benefits equally throughout the Community. We are undergoing processes of continuous and substantial industrial reorganization and regional redistribution, in which there will be those who benefit and those who are marginalized, if compensatory policies are not developed.

The first dimension of the social and economic cohesion which has taken shape has been solidarity between the regions. We, Socialists, consider that the doubling of the structural funds by 1993 is a minimum commitment, which must be realised. To achieve this, it is necessary to work in a co-ordinated manner at all levels - local, regional, State

and Community - to work out integrated programmes of Community interest.

Effective regional policies require more than just budgetary increases. They depend on the political will to change the structures and the insertion of regional criteria into all aspects of economic and social policy. If a regional policy is not developed, the process of integration of the Community will be delayed.

We consider a priority to be the concentration of development effort in the least favoured regions, as set out in objectives 1, 2 and 5 (depressed regions, regions in industrial decline, adjustments to the agricultural structures and development of rural areas) of the Rules of the Structural Funds, without forgetting objectives 3 and 4 (centered on the fight against long-term unemployment and the training for professional work of young people and women.)

Economic and social cohesion is not only limited to regional development policy. It is the driving force which must be an integral part of all policies being developed in the Community.

For this reason, in addition to solidarity, cohesion also includes:

- the necessity for convergence of economic policies and also for coherence in the process of progressive social harmonisation and fiscal harmonisation, in so far as this is necessary for the internal market and does not limit the revenue of any Member State;
- common industrial standards necessary to create one market, especially in high technology products, where the fragmented European market has been a problem for their development in the past;
- taking into account, in the application of the common agricultural policy, the differences of capacity, conditions and product varieties;

- bearing in mind the different situations in each country in the environmental field.

Accordingly, as is the case in each country for its own regions, cohesion calls for a degree of coherence in all community policies, in order to be able to bear in mind all types of inequality and to achieve an approximation of levels of development. (*)

The construction of Europe cannot be limited to its economic and social dimensions. Therefore, we support cultural initiatives promoted by the Commission, the European Parliament, as well as by the Council of Europe. The implementation of a common policy in the field of high definition television and in the broadcasting networks, as well as the creation of a European Council of Television and Audio-Visual Arts, are important steps in this process. At all levels we must seek to raise broadcasting standards, both in access and production, and to ensure that the freedoms of information and expression, as essential democratic rights, are upheld throughout the Community.

Europe is rich both in its cultural diversity and its universal vocation which must be maintained and fostered. Thus, it is necessary to protect minority languages and cultures and to favour their access to the media.

When Europe prepares its future, it should allow young people to build their future. Therefore, it is necessary to encourage all initiatives which allow young people to strengthen their European Identity. Sports activities in Europe, involving both Member and non-Member States of the Community, are also useful for building Europe.

For Socialists, Social Europe is a basic element for the construction of a citizens' Europe. The European Social Charter is its cornerstone, and it must be recognised as such by all the Community Member States.

From that starting point, Community social legislation must be prepared so as to define the basis of economic democracy, social protection, safety and health at work, vocational equality and equality of opportunity for men and women, freedom of movement and the mutual recognition of diplomas and qualifications, and the rights of immigrants. The main themes which characterize economic democracy and are supported by the European Socialists are: the participation of workers and their representatives in company decision-making; the right to information, consultation and negotiation within the company on all problems which concern organisation and working conditions; the participation of staff representatives in conciliation and the elaboration of sectoral and regional development programmes (at regional, national and Community level).

The development of the dialogue between the social partners within the Community framework must be another basic feature of the Social Europe. Negotiations between the Social Partners must be initiated in order to regulate the position of multinationals and introduce minimum standards in the professional sectors, in order to avoid the phenomenon of 'social dumping' and in order to achieve a negotiated approach based on solidarity.

European citizens are entitled to a good system of social security. In accordance with the Single European Act, we support the improvement of the level of social security in all EC countries, if necessary by upward harmonization, as this is the basis of social progress.

We draw attention to the urgency of moving towards this social objective, which has so far been the one which has

made the least progress. There is talk of prosperity to come, but it should not be forgotten that the fruits of development must be shared out. We therefore reiterate our view that the welfare state must be maintained and enhanced.

Social and sexual equality should be an integral part of the Social Europe we strive for.

The creation of the free internal market will not automatically have positive effects on the situation of women. In order to ensure that women also can move freely within the EC Member States, their economic independence should be assured. In all EC countries a reasonable level of child care facilities, child allowances etc. should be available. The Social Europe we strive for must cater for men and women alike. To achieve this goal, we need:

- the implementation of existing directives for women's equality,
- progress concerning proposed directives on part-time work, flexible daily working hours, parental leave, etc.,
- extensive training and re-training of women,
- a 'positive action' directive in favour of women, .-
- improvement of the situation of migrant women; ---- the elimination of sexual harassment and sexual violence against women and children,
- equal participation of women and men in all parliaments, governments, local, national and international institutions, as well as in the decision-making bodies of political parties.

We must also assure the right to vote for all Community residents in the European elections and permit immigrants, who have resided a certain time in a country, to participate in local political life.

We, Socialists, must persist in our fight against racism and xenophobia, the fascist and regressive threats which, poten-

tially, menace our democracies. The Community must continue to be a place of asylum, tolerance and freedom.

We call upon all Community citizens, in accordance with the Declaration of the three Community Institutions of 11 June 1986, to reject all forms of segregation and discrimination against non-EC citizens residing in our Member States.

We do not believe that systematic de-regulation and the reversal of social progress can take us forward. All that can result from this is an increase in inequality and the emergence of new forms of poverty, polarizing society and destroying social cohesion. The construction of a Community without frontiers requires an active policy of solidarity and collective social responsibility.

We want a Community fit to live in,

because we want to make economic development compatible with the protection of nature.

The sheer size of the recent environmental catastrophes and continuing environmental degradation have made it clear that the role of the EC is crucial in this respect.

Achieving the completion of the internal market by 1992 presents an opportunity to ensure that the highest possible standards are adopted and implemented in all EEC countries, for the protection of the environment, as well as ensuring the health and safety of all citizens.

Despite the fact that a large number of conventions on environmental protection have been agreed, the problems are still worsening, especially resulting from increasing toxic emissions but also from the fact that the conventions do not function effectively enough. What is needed are more binding agreements. Pollution does not stop at national borders and, therefore, national policies for environmental protection are not enough to cope with the problem by themselves, but require trans-frontier co-operation, not only at EC level, but also between the European Community and EFTA and, indeed, globally between Eastern and Western Europe.

Important areas are, inter alia:

- climatic change: countering the 'greenhouse' effect of the production of carbon dioxide and other substances which tend to raise the temperature of the world's atmosphere;
- protection of the ozone-layer Scientific data indicate that CFC emissions must be very substantially reduced in line with the Montreal Agreement, in order to re-establish the ozone-layer over Antarctica;
- the establishment of a scientific programme to strengthen research on stratospheric ozone;
- pollution of the atmosphere: reducing sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxide emissions from large combustion plants, reducing car and lorry exhaust gases; making unleaded petrol more widely available,
- conservation of the biological resources of the oceans, - water protection and measures to minimize damage to the marine environment, such as a ban on all dumping of wastes at sea, as well as measures to effect, within the next decade, a substantial reduction of discharges of all toxic substances into the marine environment from land-based sources, including the controlled and restricted use of fertilizers;
- accidents affecting the environment: working out common safety rules; introducing an early warning system, - intensive research and development in technology which is compatible with high environmental standards and prevents further pollution, with new policies to encourage re-use or recycling of waste products being pursued vigorously;
- measures to prevent and fight the dangers of desertification in many areas of Europe, as a consequence of erosion and forest fires.
- prevention of radioactive emissions, and the universal adoption of nuclear waste disposal and storage standards.

Environmental problems have increased in importance for Eastern European countries and there is a growing awareness of the urgent attention which needs to be given to finding a viable solution. Greater technological cooperation is needed between the countries of Eastern and Western Europe.

As a new form of environmental co-operation, the idea of a large scale project similar to the EUREKA model, involving several countries, could be imagined. Also, more EUREKA projects, on developing special clean technologies or technologies for the fight against pollution, should be promoted. This would ensure that both EC countries and EFTA countries would participate in the project, in order to solve a specific environmental problem in the most efficient way.

For all these reasons, we propose the launching of a European investment programme for the protection of the environment, supporting local, regional and national efforts, taking into account the main problems in Central and Northern Europe (acid rain, death of forests, North Sea pollution) and the specific problems of Southern Europe (erosion, risk of desertification, pollution of the Mediterranean).

This programme demands that we persevere with the policy of energy-saving, giving decisive support to the promotion of forms of energy which do not harm the environment and the creation of an independent Community agency for monitoring the environment.

We want a democratic Community

endowed with institutions which operate in accordance with the fundamental values of parliamentary democracy.

We, Socialists, believe that progress along the road to European unity, as defined by the Single European Act, will be achieved only if the citizens of Europe and their elected representatives participate in the decision-making process. The process of bringing into being the Single Act has paved the way towards progress in the democratic and effective functioning of the Community Institutions.

The solution of the outstanding financial and budgetary problems has enabled us to concentrate our efforts on the real priorities. The rapidly changing world political and economic situation makes us mindful of the need to strengthen the Community. The strengthening of the Community is the task of each and every one of the Member States. It is clear that the 1992 objectives will demand major changes in the EEC. The creation of the internal market is leading to a profound restructuring of economic power. Accordingly, it is necessary to reinforce the machinery of democratic control, so as to ensure that vested interests do

not accumulate excessive power at the expense of the citizens and their elected representatives. It is a matter of absolute priority to complete the legal framework and strengthen the Institutions in such a way that the Community authorities will be able to defend the public interest. (')

As the volume and pace of decision-making in the EC has increased in the run up to 1992, faults in the Community's democratic processes have emerged. These are both within and between the EC's own Institutions, as well as at the national level.

Unfortunately, the loss of control on the part of the national parliaments has not been offset by a parallel increase in the responsibilities of the European Parliament. The touchstone of Community democracy is respect for parliamentary democracy as the system which, with most certainty, safeguards the rule of law and the rights of citizens.

Socialists want the Community's Institutions to work as effectively as possible. The democratisation of the Community will require a major improvement in its Institutions and a better inter-institutional balance. No area of EC policy should be exempt from parliamentary control and the European Parliament must play a key role in the democratic control of the Community and the Community's decision-making process. Accordingly, we affirm that the changes agreed upon in the Single Act and the achievement of the 1992 objective make institutional progress within the Community necessary.

The primary task of the Parliament to be elected will be to prepare a foundation for the reforms. The European Parliament rendered the Single Act possible by means of the 1984 Draft Treaty on European Union; it now has the duty and responsibility of laying the foundation, on a democratic basis, for the next step forward.

The political and institutional reality of the European Institutions is based on a twofold democratic legitimacy: at national level, embodied in the Council, and at Community level, embodied in the Parliament and the Commission.

Progress towards the achievement of European unity must recognize this dual legitimacy as its starting point. Therefore, cooperation between the European Parliament and the Parliaments of the Member States is absolutely necessary. Likewise, support both for political and social forces and for citizens in general is of fundamental importance. We, thus, regard as positive the various public initiatives, events and consultation in favour of European unity. However, the most decisive event at the present time is the election of the European Parliament in 1989.

Socialists put forward, as fundamental institutional objectives for the work of the next European Parliament, the following: -The strengthening of power and democratic legitimacy of the Commission which must receive a vote of investiture from the European Parliament.

-The progressive realisation of a system of full co-decision making between the Council of Ministers and Parliament in all areas of Community legislation by extension of the cooperation procedure agreed in the Single Act, which, at present, only applies to matters regarding the completion of the Internal Market. This extension of the cooperation procedure would have to go hand in hand with the extension of majority voting in the Council of Ministers. -Participation by the Parliament in decisions on Community budget income is a fundamental element of political responsibility. The contribution made to the Community must be agreed according to the contributory capacity of the states and citizens, introducing a criterion of progressivity in order that justice and cohesion become a reality.

- For Socialists, respect for the; Inter-Institutional Agreement of June 1988 on 'budgetary discipline and improvement of the budgetary procedure' is an essential element for the rigorous monitoring and management of Community funds.
- The development of the system of guaranteeing and protecting the rights of citizens in the field of Community legislation. (k)

Europe must play an active role in the world.

We, Socialists, consider that a United Europe must play an active role in the world in ensuring peace, freedom and development.

Western Europe must have a bigger role in policies concerning peace, security and disarmament. To that end, ever more effective cooperation is necessary. On important matters of international policy, the European Community must help to achieve peace, justice, respect for human rights and a better development policy.

This means that Western Europe must progressively increase its responsibility regarding security policy as a dimension of foreign policy, through the strengthening of cooperation. The objective is not to create a new military super-power but, rather, to contribute, through political action, diplomatic initiatives and economic and ecological cooperation, to the reduction of tension and the creation of areas of freedom, democracy and autonomy in the world. To this end, the Community should play a more concrete and active diplomatic role in the solution of regional conflicts, as well as conflicts concerning Member States or countries associated with the Community, such as the withdrawal of

foreign occupying forces from Cyprus and the respect for its integrity and independence,,

We are aware of the importance of the debate concerning the WEU. Its revitalization and recent enlargement to include two more Community countries must be acknowledged. The WEU does not, however, replace the cooperation on some aspects of security policy within the context of EPC, as provided for in Article 30(5) of the Single European Act. We believe that the WEU must be open to new members. We also believe that the strengthening of the European role on security and disarmament must be used to promote a policy of 'détente' between East and West. In this debate, the specific situation of Ireland has to be taken into account, whose neutral status, which is reflected in the Single European Act, must be fully recognised and respected.

The reduction of antagonisms and armaments in Europe must go hand in hand with an increase in trust and cooperation. The Community is the nucleus of the peaceful and free union of the democratic States of Western Europe. The aim is still to create a peaceful European order, which is the objective of the Helsinki Final Act and through which the [C.S.C.E. process](#) can be brought to a successful conclusion. We call for the creation of an independent impartial institute of European peace and security policy, which should research all aspects of European security and disarmament policy and contribute to political analyses and information. With regard to our EFTA neighbours, we welcome the progress achieved in the direction of a European economic zone, linking them in an equitable fashion with the Community countries, at the same time as the Community itself is creating the Single Market by the end of 1992. We are prepared, in the next few years, to welcome favourably any application for accession to the Community from any of our EFTA partners.

The closer cooperation between EC and EFTA countries

Agreements. This must include a common search for a Social Europe and the solution of important environmental problems. While paying close attention to national sensitivities, the relationship must be strengthened to achieve and share the benefits and costs of economic, industrial and political cooperation.

We, Socialists, cannot allow a divided Europe to be a permanent state of affairs. We wish to eliminate the barriers which separate the European peoples. The most effective means of doing so is to promote cooperation and the development of political, economic, cultural and human relations with all the States and peoples of Eastern Europe. The establishment of relations between the EEC and COMECON is an historic step which is of benefit to all. The economic growth potential of the COMECON countries is substantial, provided that they are capable of pursuing their declared intention of making profound economic and social reforms. Their success is in the interests of everyone.) In this context, we consider that it is of fundamental importance to give effect to all the elements of the Final Act of Helsinki. Every improvement, relating to internal democracy and the respect for human rights in Eastern Europe, will lead to an improvement in inter-European mutual relations on the level of governments and through dialogue with all political forces in the Eastern European countries which are favourable to political and economic reforms, leading to democratisation and pluralism.

Today, the system of nuclear deterrence is an element of the military security system in Europe. Our long term aim is still to overcome the system of mutual deterrence by arms reductions and by reducing antagonisms within a peaceful European and world order. As long as nuclear weapons exist, they should only be instruments for deterrence, never for war-fighting. We are committed, however, to reducing the scale and impact of that component. In particular, we wish to reach the situation where conventional stability enables both alliances to abolish all non-strategic nuclear weapons.

We strongly support the INF (Intermediate-range Nuclear Forces) agreement which eliminates the categories of land-based intermediate-range nuclear missiles of both long- and short-range. The agreement reduces the continental range nuclear threat in Europe and Asia. It reduces the danger of nuclear intimidation against non-nuclear weapon states. It proves the possibility of nuclear disarmament. It establishes the precedent of effective verification, including the principle of on-site inspection and asymmetric force reductions.

The true benefits of the INF agreement depend on the ability to follow-up with complementary agreements which can form a structure of stability, and on the ability to prevent compensatory dispositions which would redirect the arms race in other, possibly more dangerous, directions. Therefore, we oppose measures, including so-called 'modernisation', which would amount to compensation for the elimination of intermediate range missiles or a circumvention in spirit or letter of the INF treaty. Now is the time for negotiation, not for modernisation.

We strongly support the conclusion of a START (Strategic Arms Reduction Talks) agreement involving a 50% reduction in the strategic nuclear forces of the United States and the Soviet Union. In addition to its intrinsic importance for the future of Soviet-American relations and for capping and reversing the nuclear arms race, such an agreement would serve also to stabilise the INF Treaty by making it more difficult to circumvent it de facto, by allocating ICBMs (Inter-Continental Ballistic Missiles), SLCMs (Submarine-Launched Ballistic Missiles), and SLCMs (Sea-Launched Cruise Missiles) to targets in Europe.

We believe, furthermore, that limitations and restrictions on nuclear tipped SLCMs should be established in conjunction with a 50% strategic reduction agreement. Such limitations are important in general, in order to prevent another diversion of the nuclear arms race and, specifically, in order to

protect Europe as a whole, and its flanks in particular, against the emerging threat from land-attack nuclear SLCMs.

We are totally opposed to an extension of the arms race on Earth to outer space. Outer space should be preserved as a common area for humankind. All deployments of weapons should be barred from outer space. The military uses of space should be confined to observation, navigation and communication. Consequently, we oppose testing and deployment of anti-ballistic missiles systems in space. We are opposed to the development and deployment of space- and non-space based strategic missile defence systems. Hence, we insist on strict adherence to the provisions of the ABM (Anti-Ballistic Missile) Treaty, in consonance with their interpretation when the American Senate ratified the agreement. In our view, the offensive threat from ballistic missiles should be reduced by agreements for mutual build-down, rather than by unilateral measures of elusive protection which would only lead to further proliferation of offensive systems. Progress in this regard will aid the efforts to conclude a Comprehensive Nuclear Test Ban Treaty (CTBT). In this connection, we welcome the progress towards CIS supplementary accords which will facilitate ratification of the Threshold Test Ban Treaty (TTBT). A CTBT would be an effective means of stemming the process of nuclear modernisation and of obtaining universal adherence to the Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT).

In the years ahead, negotiations about conventional stability in Europe will be of paramount importance to peace on our continent. The aim of such negotiations should be conventional stability at the lowest possible level of forces. The negotiations should deal with the conventional forces of the two alliances in all of Europe. The 23 nations of the two alliances should conduct their negotiations within the framework of the 35-nation CSCE (Conference on Security

and Cooperation in Europe). The primary purpose of the negotiations should be to enhance stability. This should be achieved through asymmetric reductions, with the aim of establishing common ceilings substantially below current force levels. Furthermore, it should be achieved through a preferential reduction and withdrawal of particularly offensive capacities. Dual- and triple-capable systems should not be excluded from the negotiations because of their capacity to deliver nuclear or chemical munitions. A first conventional reduction agreement should reduce capacities for surprise attack, sustained offensive action and occupation of territory. This should be accompanied by a second generation of CSCE confidence- and security-building measures (CSBMs), designed to enhance transparency and predictability, concerning military dispositions in Europe.

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In consonance with a comprehensive concept which encompasses the inter-relation between the conventional and nuclear components in our force planning and negotiating strategy, we believe that negotiations should take place on tactical nuclear weapons with a range below 500 kilometres, as well as conventional forces, in a way which, at any time, contributes to stability in Europe. In order to enhance stability and to complement and reinforce a conventional stability agreement, we believe that primary attention should be devoted to the reduction and withdrawal of battlefield nuclear weapons. Their short range, limited number of munition depots and war-fighting rationale contribute to dangerous instability in the event of a crisis. We support the idea of corridors with no nuclear weapons and particularly no offensive conventional armaments, as a confidencebuilding measure and an integral element in a regime for stability in Europe. Sub-regional nuclear-weapon-free zones, as part of an overall arrangement for reducing nuclear weapons in Europe, could similarly contribute to stability and security in Europe as a whole.

The military postures and strategies or doctrines of both alliances must be designed to prevent attack, and to

preserve stability. Particular attention should be paid to the size, structure, deployment and peace-time disposition of forces, in order to preserve a coherent overall posture for security and arms control. In the development of a credible military strategy for a period of intensified negotiation, the following principles should be observed by both alliances: - They should emphasise deployments and dispositions which capitalise on and, as far as possible, reduce inherent threats of offensive action.

-They should reduce theatre nuclear arsenals by moving away from nuclear artillery with its attendant dangers of preemptive and early use in a crisis or in the early phases of a war.

We demand that an agreement be concluded banning and eliminating chemical weapons throughout the world, with an international monitoring system. If this agreement is not reached in a short period, the creation of a chemicalweapons-free zone in the whole of Europe will be necessary. We believe that an agreed policy of reduction of military spending is of benefit to all. The resources thus liberated can be used to strengthen North-South co-operation and the solution of social problems.

We, European Socialists, consider that the challenge of the future is worldwide. Cooperation with the countries of the Third World must be inspired by principles of justice, solidarity, peace and development.

We advocate the establishment of a new international economic order. We believe the reform and strengthening of the GATT system is a prior condition for the improvement of trade. The current 'Uruguay Round' must provide developing countries with greater access to markets in industrialized countries. It is, moreover, necessary to introduce a new 'social clause' into the rules of GATT, with the aim of ensuring respect for ILO minimum working conditions throughout the

world. We advocate a stricter international Code of Conduct for multinational companies, particularly with regard to their operations in developing countries. The reform of GATT must go hand-in-hand with the re-establishment of stability in world trade, as well as the provision of extra resources to the IMF, the World Bank, and its International Development Association (IDA), paying special attention to the Least Developed Countries. The Community must press for changes in the economic adjustment programmes of the IMF, so that there is no worsening of social problems in developing countries.

Accordingly, we consider that it is of fundamental importance for the Community to be able to give consistent meaning to development aid as a basic feature of its common external policy.

Following its own experience, it must promote and support processes of regional integration and cooperation. In that regard, it is very important to reshape the Community's co-operation policy, with a view to the achievement of the internal market in 1992.

This requires the launching of an emergency financial plan for the Third World, financed by all the developed countries on the basis of increasing towards 0.7% of GNP, in line with U N resolutions, with a co-ordinated strategy with the private banking sector, designed to resolve the problem of Third World indebtedness. The principal lines of action could be: remission of the debts of the poorest countries, renegotiation of the overall debt, the extension of repayment periods and the reduction of interest rates.

The Lomé Convention is one of the symbols of Community cooperation, by virtue of its contractual basis and multi-annual character. We consider that its renegotiation will contribute to stability of trade patterns, increased aid in the form of long-term programmes, centred on training, education

and the creation of a regional framework. The EEC should offer the possibility for other countries to join the Lomé Convention.

We must continue to condemn and oppose Apartheid and to support those who are struggling to eliminate it. We believe it is necessary to strengthen a sanctions policy, which obliges the South African racist regime to abandon its - abominable principles. At the same time, we must continue actively to support the Frontline and SADCC States and the process of independence for Namibia.

The enlargement of the Community has given rise to new perspectives in two important areas: the Mediterranean region and the Latin American region.

- The Community, today, is the foremost Mediterranean power. It must face up to its responsibilities, in the first place by pursuing a common policy to achieve peace in the Middle East.

Peace in the Middle East must rest on the right of the Palestinian people to self-determination and the right to guaranteed frontiers for all the states in the region, Israel included.

- The decision adopted at the meeting in Algiers of the National Council of the PLO, as the legitimate representative of the Palestinian people, on the recognition of Israel and the renunciation of terrorism, while calling on the Israeli Government to accept the opening of a dialogue with the Palestinians, taking into account, finally, the direct dialogue which took place between the PLO and the USA, demonstrates that the conditions for holding an International Conference under the aegis of the UN are being realised.
- In the meantime, we support the idea that the Occupied Territories pass under international control.
- The European Community must play an active role, in order to encourage the evolution of the situation towards

the realisation of these objectives, while at the same time increasing its humanitarian aid to the population of the Occupied Territories, supporting all initiatives which promote economic and social development in the region.

It is of particular importance that the countries of North Africa are able to increase their economic growth and accelerate their social development, particularly faced with the rate of increase in their demographic growth. This is why we support the present process of regional integration and why we are in favour of the reinforcement of economic cooperation between the EEC and the Mediterranean countries.

-As regards Latin America, we support the processes of regional integration that are under way there. Europe must increase its involvement in the peace-making process in Central America, by means of a policy of increasingly active support for political dialogue and the consolidation of democracy. The EEC must adopt a more open policy regarding the restrictions which exist, at present, in trade with the Latin American countries. Latin America has historic links with the Community of Twelve. This is why we support the adoption of preferential trade agreements, leading to increased trade, which would be one of the best ways of overcoming the present debt crisis. Likewise, the establishment of closer relations must extend to the scientific and technical spheres.

Half of humanity lives in the developing countries of Asia. In some of these countries, the worst levels of poverty are recorded. Help to Southern Asian countries must constitute one of the Community's priorities, especially with reference to rural development. It is necessary to encourage the development of trade between their respective regions. It is also necessary to develop relations between the Community and China.

We also advocate a strengthening of relations between the Community and the other industrialized democracies in the

framework of the OECD. In particular, the Community should take the initiative to establish greater macro-economic cooperation, in order to avoid a repetition of the recession of the early 1980s and to ensure sustained economic growth and high levels of employment in the future.

The Community wants international trade to be regulated according to the GATT Rules. The Community must steadfastly oppose protectionist tendencies by rejecting unilateral protectionist measures, such as the US Omnibus Trade Act, as well as the continuing policy of restricting access to the Japanese internal market.

Achievement of the internal market is a development which arouses hopes, tinged with a degree of concern on the part of our main partners. Europe has taken the first step to show its willingness to adopt an attitude of openness by its decision to reform the CAP, a path which, in the opinion of the Socialists, must continue to be followed if we wish to establish a stable world economic order.

A more united Europe will be a factor contributing to stability in matters of politics, finance and world trade and a positive element in shaping a fairer and more just world order. The Community has emerged substantially strengthened from its financial and institutional crisis. Facing the 1990s, it must be prepared to deal with even greater political, economic and social challenges with one objective: to establish the unity of our countries and our peoples in Europe.

The present pace towards European unity must be maintained and strengthened. As Socialists, committed to the cause of a people's Europe, we are prepared to play our key role in this exciting new phase in the development of European unity.